

National & Gandhian Mass Movements

Swadeshi to Quit India — phases, methods, social base and why questions repeat.

Portion focus ~46% · Topic: hist-modern

PYQ themes: Non-Cooperation · Civil Disobedience/Salt · Quit India · Revolutionary strand

Why UPSC asks this

Movement chronology and method differences are perennial discriminators.

Phase logic

Study nationalism as shifting strategies: Moderates' petition politics; Extremists' Swadeshi; Gandhian mass satyagraha; revolutionary terrorism; Left and peasant/worker strands; Subhas/INA. UPSC tests whether you can place a method in the right decade.

Gandhian experiments

Champaran (indigo), Kheda (revenue), Ahmedabad (mill workers) precede all-India NCM. Non-Cooperation paired with Khilafat; Chauri Chaura halted the movement. Civil Disobedience opened with Dandi; Round Table Conferences and Gandhi–Irwin Pact are checkpoint facts. Quit India (1942) under “Do or Die” amid wartime repression — leaders imprisoned, spontaneous parallel activity.

Beyond Gandhi

Keep bullets on Bhagat Singh/HSRA, Surya Sen, women in movements, and peasant/tribal uprisings as complementary PYQ pools.

Must remember

- 1919–22 NCM + Khilafat; 1930 Salt March/CDM; 1942 Quit India
- Champaran, Kheda, Ahmedabad — early satyagrahas
- INA & INA trials — later nationalist emotion

Educational prioritisation heuristic — not an official UPSC prediction. © UPSC IAS Study Hub original notes.